



In 1502, while working for Cesare Borgia, Leonardo combined his artistic and engineering skills to draw this map of the city of Imola.

So Leonardo began traveling with Borgia's army, evaluating the condition of fortresses and castles along the way. Although Borgia had no interest in Leonardo's paintings, he greatly valued another aspect of Leonardo's artistic abilities—his skill at drawing maps.

Maps were still pretty rare at the time, but an experienced commander like Cesare Borgia immediately saw how useful they could be in warfare. An army that could clearly see where it was going and what it would face in its path was an army that would be more likely to win.

